

Sample School Based Assessment (SBA) Tools for English and Literature

Ready-to-use assessment tools in the familiar school format: details, instructions, marking criteria and signatures.

These are samples, not official instructions

Each tool is set out in the usual **School Based Assessment tool** format. Fill in your school's name and the date. **For Grades 6 to 11 English, the competency and competency level numbers are taken from the NIE English Language Teachers' Guides** for those grades (see [Competency Levels by Grade](#)). The Grade 6 guide used is the edition implemented from 2015, so schools on the new 2026 Grade 6 syllabus should use the numbers in the new guide. For primary grades, A/L General English and Literature we do not yet have the Teachers' Guides, so the competency wording there is a sample: copy the official competency and level from your guide. Follow the SBA plan and circulars for your grade and year for the number of tools, their timing and how marks are recorded. The terms shown in the Literature tools are suggestions; change them to suit your school's plan.

English: Primary (Grades 2 to 5)

SBA plan 1: Show and tell

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	2 / 3
Subject	English
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Oral presentation
Time duration	1 to 2 minutes per pupil (over two periods)
Competency	Uses simple spoken English to talk about familiar things.
Competency level	Names and describes a familiar object in simple sentences. (Sample wording: use the competency level in your Teacher's Guide.)
Subject content	Things at home and in school; colours and sizes
Nature of the tool	Individual oral presentation
Learning outcome	Pupils will be able to say three simple sentences about an object they bring from home.
Teacher's activity	Models a short show-and-tell with an object, gives the sentence frames (This is my ... It is ... I like it because ...), and calls pupils one by one.
Students' activity	Bring an object from home and say at least three sentences about it to the class.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Names the object in a full sentence	05

Criteria	Marks
Describes it (colour, size or use)	05
Speaks clearly enough to be understood	05
Speaks with confidence and little prompting	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____

Principal: _____

SBA plan 2: Listen and do

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	2 / 3
Subject	English
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Listening test (practical)
Time duration	One period
Competency	Listens to and follows simple spoken instructions.
Competency level	Responds correctly to one-step and two-step instructions. (Sample wording: use the competency level in your Teacher's Guide.)
Subject content	Action words, classroom objects, colours
Nature of the tool	Whole-class practical listening task
Learning outcome	Pupils will be able to carry out simple instructions given in English.
Teacher's activity	Gives instructions one at a time (Stand up. Touch your nose. Colour the ball red.), repeating each once, and records each pupil's responses on a checklist.
Students' activity	Listen and carry out each instruction, including drawing and colouring on a worksheet.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Follows action instructions	05
Follows instructions with objects	05
Follows colouring and drawing instructions	05
Follows two-step instructions	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____

Principal: _____

SBA plan 3: My picture book

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	4 / 5
Subject	English
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Assignment (creative work)
Time duration	Two periods
Competency	Writes simple sentences about familiar topics.
Competency level	Writes one or two sentences to match a picture. (Sample wording: use the competency level in your Teacher's Guide.)
Subject content	My family / My school
Nature of the tool	Individual picture book
Learning outcome	Pupils will be able to write simple, correctly punctuated sentences about their own pictures.
Teacher's activity	Shows a sample picture book, revises capital letters and full stops, and helps pupils plan four pages.
Students' activity	Draw four pictures about their family or school and write one or two sentences under each.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Every picture has a matching sentence	05
Sentences make sense	05
Capital letters and full stops are correct	05
Book is neat and complete	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____

Principal: _____

SBA plan 4: Reading aloud

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	4 / 5
Subject	English
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Oral test (reading)
Time duration	2 minutes per pupil
Competency	Reads short texts aloud with understanding.
Competency level	Reads a practised text accurately and fluently. (Sample wording: use the competency level in your Teacher's Guide.)
Subject content	A short practised passage of about 60 words
Nature of the tool	Individual reading-aloud test
Learning outcome	Pupils will be able to read a short passage aloud accurately, in phrases, with a clear voice.
Teacher's activity	Chooses and practises the passage with the class, then listens to each pupil and marks on a class sheet.
Students' activity	Read the practised passage aloud to the teacher.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Reads the words accurately	05
Reads in phrases, not word by word	05
Pauses at full stops and commas	05
Uses a clear, audible voice	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____

Principal: _____

English: Junior secondary (Grades 6 to 9)

SBA plan 5: Role play

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	6 / 7
Subject	English
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Role play
Time duration	One period for preparation, 3 minutes per pair
Competency	Competency 8: Communicates clearly, fluently and concisely
Competency level	8.13 Uses language in variety of contexts (Grades 6 and 7)
Subject content	Asking for and giving directions / shopping
Nature of the tool	Pair role play
Learning outcome	Students will be able to complete an everyday conversation using the expressions from the unit.
Teacher's activity	Revises the useful expressions, gives each pair a situation card, and assesses each pair during the performance.
Students' activity	Prepare and act out the situation in pairs, with a clear start and end.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Completes the task in the situation	05
Uses the unit's expressions correctly	05
Speaks fluently with few long pauses	05
Pronounces clearly and responds to the partner	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____

Principal: _____

SBA plan 6: Instruction poster

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	6 / 7
Subject	English
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Assignment (poster)
Time duration	Two periods
Competency	Competency 7: Uses English creatively and innovatively in written communication
Competency level	7.4 Writes instructions (Grades 6 and 7)
Subject content	Preventing dengue / making a cup of tea
Nature of the tool	Individual or pair poster
Learning outcome	Students will be able to write at least six clear instructions using imperatives and sequence words.
Teacher's activity	Shows a model poster, revises imperatives and sequence words, and gives the topics.
Students' activity	Make a poster with a heading, pictures and at least six instructions in order.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Relevant instructions in the right order	05
Correct imperatives and sequence words	05
Clear layout with heading and pictures	05
Neat and readable from a distance	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____

Principal: _____

SBA plan 7: Reading log

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	7 / 8 / 9
Subject	English
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Portfolio
Time duration	One term
Competency	Competency 5: Extracts necessary information from various types of texts
Competency level	5.5 Reads and understands simple folk stories (Grade 7) / Reads and responds to simple folk stories / stories (Grade 8) / Reads and responds to simple folk tales (Grade 9); 5.6 Extracts the general idea of a text (Grades 7, 8 and 9)
Subject content	Three short books or stories chosen by the student
Nature of the tool	Individual reading portfolio
Learning outcome	Students will be able to summarise stories and give reasons for their opinions.
Teacher's activity	Explains the log format, helps students choose readers, and checks the log twice during the term.
Students' activity	Keep a log with a five-sentence summary and an opinion with reasons for each of three books or stories.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Summaries give the main events	05
Opinions are supported by reasons	05
Sentences are mostly accurate	05
Log is complete and regularly kept	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____

Principal: _____

SBA plan 8: Class wall newspaper

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	8 / 9
Subject	English
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Group project
Time duration	Two weeks
Competency	Competency 7: Uses English creatively and innovatively in written communication
Competency level	7.5 Writes simple compositions on different types of topics (Grades 8 and 9)
Subject content	Newspaper writing: news report, notice, story or poem, puzzle
Nature of the tool	Group project
Learning outcome	Students will be able to write in different formats and work together to publish them.
Teacher's activity	Forms groups, shows sample wall newspapers, sets deadlines, and monitors each member's contribution.
Students' activity	Plan, write, edit and display a wall newspaper with at least four items; each member writes one item.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
All items present and relevant	05
Correct formats and accurate language	05
Teamwork: each member's part is shown	05
Attractive and readable presentation	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____

Principal: _____

English: O/L (Grades 10 and 11)

SBA plan 9: Formal letter under timed conditions

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	10 / 11
Subject	English
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Written test
Time duration	30 minutes
Competency	Competency 7: Uses English creatively and innovatively in written communication
Competency level	7.7 Writes for official purposes (Grades 10 and 11)
Subject content	Letter of complaint or request on a local issue
Nature of the tool	Individual timed writing
Learning outcome	Students will be able to write a formal letter of about 150 words with the correct format and tone.
Teacher's activity	Sets the task with clear points to include, and supervises the timed writing.
Students' activity	Write a formal letter covering all the given points in 30 minutes.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Correct format (addresses, date, salutation, subject, close)	05
All points covered with detail	05
Clear paragraphs	05
Accurate grammar and a suitable formal tone	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____

Principal: _____

SBA plan 10: Two-minute speech

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	10 / 11
Subject	English
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Speech
Time duration	2 minutes per student
Competency	Competency 8: Communicates clearly, fluently and concisely
Competency level	8.4 Speaks on familiar topics (Grades 10 and 11)
Subject content	A topic from the textbook (for example healthy food or careers)
Nature of the tool	Individual speech
Learning outcome	Students will be able to deliver an organised two-minute speech.
Teacher's activity	Gives topics a week ahead, shows how to open and close a speech, and marks each speech.
Students' activity	Prepare and deliver a two-minute speech with an opening, main points and a closing.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Clear main idea with supporting points	05
Opening, body and closing	05
Accurate and varied language	05
Audible delivery with eye contact	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____

Principal: _____

SBA plan 11: Survey and report

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	10 / 11
Subject	English
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Assignment
Time duration	Two periods
Competency	Competency 5: Extracts necessary information from various types of texts
Competency level	5.3 Transfers information into other forms (Grades 10 and 11)
Subject content	Class survey and bar chart
Nature of the tool	Individual or pair report
Learning outcome	Students will be able to present survey results in a bar chart and a short report.
Teacher's activity	Explains how to conduct a survey and describe a chart, and gives useful phrases.
Students' activity	Conduct a class survey, draw a bar chart and write a short report on the findings.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Accurate, labelled chart	05
Main findings described	05
Comparison language used correctly	05
Accurate sentences	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____

Principal: _____

English: A/L General English (Grades 12 and 13)

SBA plan 12: Group presentation

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	12 / 13
Subject	General English
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Presentation
Time duration	5 minutes per group
Competency	Presents information clearly to an audience.
Competency level	Delivers a structured presentation with signposting. (Sample wording: use the competency level in your Teacher's Guide.)
Subject content	A textbook topic (for example the cyber world or continuing education)
Nature of the tool	Group presentation
Learning outcome	Students will be able to deliver a structured group presentation on a textbook topic.
Teacher's activity	Forms groups, assigns topics, teaches signposting language, and assesses the presentations.
Students' activity	Research, plan and deliver a five-minute presentation in which every member speaks.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Relevant, well-researched content	05
Introduction, signposting and conclusion	05
Accurate, appropriate language	05
Clear delivery and every member takes part	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____

Principal: _____

SBA plan 13: Formal email

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	12 / 13
Subject	General English
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Written test
Time duration	30 minutes
Competency	Writes formal emails for a specific purpose.
Competency level	Writes a clear formal email with the correct structure and tone. (Sample wording: use the competency level in your Teacher's Guide.)
Subject content	Email to the principal of another school about a joint event
Nature of the tool	Individual timed writing
Learning outcome	Students will be able to write a formal email that covers all the required points.
Teacher's activity	Sets the task with the required points and supervises the writing.
Students' activity	Write the email in 30 minutes.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Subject line, greeting and closing	05
All required points covered	05
Polite, formal tone	05
Accurate language	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____**Principal:** _____

SBA plan 14: Discursive essay

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	12 / 13
Subject	General English
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Written test
Time duration	45 minutes
Competency	Writes an essay that discusses both sides of an issue.
Competency level	Organises a balanced argument with examples. (Sample wording: use the competency level in your Teacher's Guide.)
Subject content	An issue from the textbook units
Nature of the tool	Individual essay
Learning outcome	Students will be able to write a balanced essay of about 250 words.
Teacher's activity	Gives two or three questions, revises essay structure, and supervises the writing.
Students' activity	Choose one question and write an essay of about 250 words.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Both sides discussed with examples	05
Introduction, balanced body and conclusion	05
Accurate and varied language	05
Clear link between ideas	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____

Principal: _____

SBA plan 15: Job application and interview

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	12 / 13
Subject	General English
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Role play and written work
Time duration	One period for the letter, 5 minutes per interview
Competency	Uses English for employment purposes.
Competency level	Writes a covering letter and answers interview questions appropriately. (Sample wording: use the competency level in your Teacher's Guide.)
Subject content	Job advertisements and covering letters (Unit 8, Employment)
Nature of the tool	Individual written task and interview
Learning outcome	Students will be able to apply for a job in writing and answer interview questions politely and clearly.
Teacher's activity	Provides advertisements, revises the covering-letter format, and conducts short interviews.
Students' activity	Write a covering letter for one advertisement and take part in a short interview for that job.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Correct covering-letter format	05
Relevant letter content	05
Clear, relevant interview answers	05
Polite and fluent manner	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____

Principal: _____

English Literature (O/L)

One of the prescribed novels is assessed by the school as well as examined, and the school chooses which. The three novels on the list shown on our O/L Literature page are *The Prince and the Pauper*, *Bringing Tony Home* and *The Vendor of Sweets*; confirm the list for your examination year.

SBA plan 16: Poetry (analysing theme and techniques)

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	11
Subject	English Literature
Date	_____
Term	2nd Term
Selected evaluation	Assignment / Creative Portfolio
Time duration	1 week (independent study + 40-minute presentation)
Competency	Responds critically to poetry by identifying themes and poetic devices.
Competency level	Explores the underlying meanings, tone and imagery used by poets to convey central messages. (Sample wording: use the competency level in your Teacher's Guide.)
Subject content	Selected O/L poems (for example To the Evening Star or Richard Cory)
Nature of the tool	Individual literary commentary portfolio
Learning outcome	Students will be able to analyse poetic techniques such as metaphor, simile and personification and explain how they contribute to the poem's theme.
Teacher's activity	Introduces the poem, explains core poetic devices, provides a rubric, and guides students on how to structure a literary commentary.
Students' activity	Select one prescribed poem, analyse three major poetic devices used in it, write a 150-word commentary, and present their main findings to the class.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Understanding of themes and central message	05
Correct identification and analysis of poetic devices	05
Structure, organisation and language accuracy	05
Presentation / oral defence	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____**Principal:** _____

SBA plan 17: Short stories (character analysis)

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	10 / 11
Subject	English Literature
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd Term
Selected evaluation	Role play and character profile
Time duration	2 periods (preparation) + 1 period (execution)
Competency	Analyses character traits, motives and relationships within a short story.
Competency level	Demonstrates empathy and critical understanding of characters by interpreting their actions and dialogue. (Sample wording: use the competency level in your Teacher's Guide.)
Subject content	Prescribed short stories (for example The Lumber Room or The Fly)
Nature of the tool	Group role play and character sketch presentation
Learning outcome	Students will be able to extract textual evidence to justify a character's behaviour and mindset.
Teacher's activity	Divides the class into small groups, assigns specific characters from a short story, and monitors the brainstorming sessions.
Students' activity	Collaborate to create a visual character profile poster and perform a short three-minute role play depicting a crucial scene from that character's perspective.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Accurate depiction of character traits based on the text	05
Use of textual evidence / references	05
Teamwork and collaboration	05
Creativity and expression (role play / poster)	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____**Principal:** _____

SBA plan 18: Novel: The Vendor of Sweets (theme exploration)

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	11
Subject	English Literature
Date	_____
Term	2nd Term
Selected evaluation	Open-book analytical essay / test
Time duration	80 minutes
Competency	Evaluates major themes and cultural conflicts in an extended text.
Competency level	Examines the generation gap, the clash of East and West, and illusion versus reality in Malgudi. (Sample wording: use the competency level in your Teacher's Guide.)
Subject content	Novel: The Vendor of Sweets by R. K. Narayan
Nature of the tool	Structured analytical essay
Learning outcome	Students will write a coherent essay analysing how the conflict between Jagan and Mali represents the clash between traditional Indian values and Western modernisation.
Teacher's activity	Formulates analytical essay prompts, sets clear guidelines for thesis statements, and ensures students have access to their unmarked novels during the session.
Students' activity	Choose one prompt, formulate a thesis statement, select appropriate quotations from The Vendor of Sweets, and write a structured essay with an introduction, body paragraphs and a conclusion.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Depth of thematic understanding	05
Effective use of textual quotations and references	05
Logical flow and argumentative strength	05
Grammar, vocabulary and mechanics	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____**Principal:** _____

SBA plan 19: Drama (dramatised reading and stagecraft)

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	10 / 11
Subject	English Literature
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Dramatised reading with director's notes
Time duration	2 periods (preparation) + 1 period (performance)
Competency	Interprets drama through performance and an understanding of dramatic techniques.
Competency level	Conveys character, mood and conflict through voice, movement and staging choices. (Sample wording: use the competency level in your Teacher's Guide.)
Subject content	Prescribed drama (The Bear or Twilight of a Crane)
Nature of the tool	Group dramatised reading with individual director's notes
Learning outcome	Students will be able to perform a key scene and explain how stage directions, dialogue and action reveal character and conflict.
Teacher's activity	Selects key scenes, explains dramatic techniques (stage directions, dramatic irony, climax), forms groups and monitors rehearsals.
Students' activity	Rehearse and perform a key scene of about four minutes, and each write a short set of director's notes (about 100 words) explaining their staging choices.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Understanding of character and conflict	05
Voice, expression and movement	05
Director's notes explain staging choices with reference to the text	05
Teamwork and preparation	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____**Principal:** _____

SBA plan 20: Novel (reading journal)

Item	Details
School name	_____
Grade	10 / 11
Subject	English Literature
Date	_____
Term	1st / 2nd / 3rd (as set in your school's SBA plan)
Selected evaluation	Reading journal (portfolio)
Time duration	Over one term, with journal checks every two weeks
Competency	Responds personally and critically to an extended text.
Competency level	Tracks plot, character development and themes across a novel. (Sample wording: use the competency level in your Teacher's Guide.)
Subject content	The novel your school has selected for SBA
Nature of the tool	Individual reading journal
Learning outcome	Students will be able to record and reflect on plot, characters and themes as they read, supported by quotations.
Teacher's activity	Explains the journal format (chapter summary, character notes, key quotation, personal response), sets the reading schedule and checks journals regularly.
Students' activity	Keep a journal entry for each chapter or section with a short summary, notes on one character, one key quotation with a comment, and a personal response.

Criteria for marking

Criteria	Marks
Accurate summaries of plot	05
Insight into character development and themes	05
Well-chosen quotations with comments	05
Regular, complete and neatly kept journal	05
Total	20

In-charge teacher: _____

Principal: _____

Complete lesson plan books are coming

These are simple sample plans. **Complete lesson plan books for every grade** will be part of **RCF Premium Resources**, which will be ready in the future. [See RCF Premium Resources](https://rcfenglish.com/teacher-resources/sba-samples/)